

4.2 Hardware	4.2.1 Understand the function of the hardware components of a computer system (central processing unit (CPU), main memory, secondary storage, input and output devices) and how they work together. 4.2.2 Understand the function of different types of memory (random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), cache, virtual memory). 4.2.3 Understand the concept of a stored program and the role of components of the CPU (control unit (CU), arithmetic/logic unit (ALU), registers, clock, address bus, data bus, control bus) in the fetch-decode-execute cycle (the Von Neumann model). 4.2.4 Understand factors that affect the performance of the CPU (clock speed, number of processor cores, size of cache, type of cache). 4.2.5 Understand how data is stored on physical devices (magnetic, optical, solid state). 4.2.6 Understand the concept of storing data in the 'cloud' and other contemporary secondary storage. 4.2.7 Understand the need for embedded systems and their functions.
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